

Webinar & Video Presentation Guidelines: 5 Key Tips

In the spirit of ensuring brand consistency, along with ‘walking the talk’ on our published advice, below please find our internal tip sheet for video interviews and webinar presentations.

1. Stage your background.

Make sure the space behind your camera is clear and uncluttered to keep the focus where it should be – on you. Any larger shot of your room in the background should be clean and organized. No passing people, animals, or distracting unmade beds in view. If you’re using a laptop, it’s also helpful to elevate it on a box on your desk so that the webcam is more at eye level.

2. Give your face the best glow with a ring light.

The importance of good lighting can’t be overemphasized, and we highly recommend purchasing an inexpensive ring light (here’s a [good option](#) that Hayley recommends). This kind of thing is also status quo for our millennial and gen Z clients. There are hundreds of options on Amazon, ranging from \$15 to \$30; choose one with a 4.5+ star rating and look at the reviews to ensure it suits your needs, like size (for laptop or phone), settings, and charging capability.

3. Fine-tune your technology.

Flawless Internet connectivity being a given, you’ll want to ensure you have excellent sound quality. Beyond ensuring a quiet space, we recommend using earphones to improve sound and cut unexpected background noise. Your voice should be clear and easy to hear while speaking at a normal pitch and volume. Please also ensure your computer settings are updated – Zoom, for example, makes frequent upgrades that require updating to function optimally (or at all). Test that your microphone is working properly, and computer settings are updated for audio. Finally, please also plan on logging on to the sessions at least 10 mins early so we can do a sound, visual, and general tech check.

4. Embrace your ‘business mullet’ style.

Most of us have had a “Zoom shirt” long before it was a pandemic-related trend (‘business mullet’ refers to formal on top, party on the bottom). And, as ‘what to wear on video’ is among our most popular blogs (link below), we’ll underscore Karen’s quip that “being memorable for the right reasons means standing out for what you say not what you wear.” [According to Stitch Fix](#), the three colors that work for everyone are blush, red, and black, although you can consult their handy guide to if you’re curious to learn more.

5. Know what we advise our current and prospective clients.

Finally, please also take a look at the specific advice we offer to candidates in our published articles, which elaborates further on topics like body language, non-verbal’s, staging, dress, and mistakes to avoid: [How to Prep for the Virtual MBA Interview: Tips for Video](#) and [MBA Interview Prep: What to Wear on Video](#).